WITS AHEAD RESEARCH GROUP

The AHEAD Fortnightly

Ushicilelo 2 · 15 uMfumfu 2026 · Wits School of Education, University of the Witwatersrand

Kula masonto amabili, umbuzo ushintshile usuka ekutheni amanyuvesi kufanele yini amukele i-AI uya ekutheni enza kanjani izinqumo. UNgqongqoshe Buti Manamela utshele ingqungquthela ye-Universities South Africa ukuthi sekuyisikhathi sokusuka engxoxweni siye ezinqumweni mayelana nokufundisa nocwaningo, kanti ososayensi bekhompyutha ababili base-Wits, abavela e-RAIL Lab, bathe i-Afrika kumele izibekele uhlelo lwayo locwaningo lwe-AI kunokuba isebenzise kuphela amathuluzi akhiwe kwenye indawo. Ngesikhathi esifanayo, amanyuvesi aphesheya ayayeka ukusebenzisa amathuluzi okuthola i-AI kanye nemibandela emisha yelayisensi ehlongozwe yi-Turnitin, okusikhumbuza ukuthi ukwethembana nokwahlulela akunakunikezwa isofthiwe. Kithina e-Wits AHEAD, yilezi zinqumo ezakha ikhono lomuntu, futhi lolu shicilelo lufika kuwe ngezilimi eziyishumi nantathu.

IZINTO EZINTATHU OKUFANELE UZAZI

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NEWS · 14 OCTOBER 2026 · GLOBAL

Joining up AI across recruitment, retention and alumni relations can close graduation gaps, if it is governed well

Ebhala ku-University World News, umqondisi wephrojekthi ye-IREX, uCameron Mirza, uthi amanyuvesi kufanele aphathe ukuqashwa kwabafundi, ukubagcina kanye nobudlelwane nabathweswe iziqu njengesigaba esisodwa esixhumene, esisekelwa yi-AI, kunokuba kube izinhlelo ezahlukene ezinedatha ehlukene. Ucaphuna uhlelo lwe-chatbot nokuhlaziywa kwedatha okubikezelayo lwe-Georgia State University, oluncomeka ngokuncishisa "ukuphela kwabafundi ehlobo" ngamaphesenti angaba ngu-21 nangokusiza abafundi abaMnyama, abangama-Hispanic, abokuqala emindenini yabo ukuya enyuvesi kanye nabampofu ukuba bathweswe iziqu ngezinga elilingana noma eledlula elabanye bonke abafundi, kuyilapho exwayisa ukuthi amamodeli aqeqeshwe ngedatha yangaphambili nawo angaqinisa ukungalingani abekelwe ukuwaxazulula.

> **Kungani kubalulekile:** Ngesinsika sika-Wits AHEAD mayelana ne-AI nokuhlaziywa kwedatha okubikezelayo kwempumelelo yabafundi, lesi sihloko siyisikhumbuzo esibalulekile sokuthi amathuluzi esexwayiso sangaphambili nokugcinwa kwabafundi avala kuphela igebe lobulungiswa uma ehambisana nokuqashwa kombono womuntu kanye nokuhlolwa kokuchema, okuyimbuzo yokulawulwa uWits AHEAD ayibuza kunoma yiliphi ithuluzi lokuhlaziya idatha aliphakamisayo.

University World News · universityworldnews.com · Funda emthonjeni

Mirza, C. (2026, October 14). How AI improves student recruitment, retention, advancement. *University World News*. universityworldnews.com/post.php?story=20261014130619431

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NEWS · 13 OCTOBER 2026 · SOUTH AFRICA

Wits researchers argue Africa must set its own AI research agenda, not just apply others' tools

Izazi zekhompuyutha ezimbili ze-University of the Witwatersrand, uBenjamin Rosman noSteve James, abangabaqondisi abahlanganyela be-Robotics, Autonomous Intelligence and Learning (RAIL) Lab, bathi i-Afrika kufanele iqhube ucwaningo lobuhlakani bokwenziwa (i-AI) hhayi nje ukusebenzisa amathuluzi akhiqizwe kwenye indawo. Babhekisa ku-Deep Learning Indaba, manje esesikhulu kunazo zonke isikole sasehlobo se-AI emhlabeni, esaheha ababambiqhaza abangu-1,300 emhlanganweni wanonyaka odlule eKigali, nolugijima uhlelo lwalo i-IndabaX emazweni angu-48 kwangu-54 ase-Afrika kulo nyaka, naku-Machine Intelligence and Neural Discovery (MIND) Institute entsha yaseWits, ehlanganisa abafundisi abacwaningi abangaba ngu-65 emikhakheni yezinto zekhompuyutha, i-neuroscience, i-psychology nenqubomgomo.

> **Kungani kubalulekile:** Ngesinsika sika-Wits AHEAD mayelana ne-AI enokuzibophezela, ukuziphatha okulungile, ubulungiswa nenqubomgomo, isixwayiso sokuthi i-Afrika ingagcini isiyindawo nje "yabanye ukuba benze isayensi" sithinta ngqo umgomo ka-Wits AHEAD wokwakha ikhono eliholwa yi-Afrika lokubeka imibuzo yocwaningo lwe-AI, hhayi nje ukusebenzisa amathuluzi e-AI aklanywe kwenye indawo.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Funda emthonjeni

Luckhurst, G. (2026, October 13). Africa has crucial role in advancing study of AI, say professors. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/africa-has-crucial-role-advancing-study-ai-say-professors

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NEWS · 9 OCTOBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

More universities end Turnitin contracts as concerns mount

I-Times Higher Education ibika ukuthi iNewcastle University kanye ne-University of Westminster zihlanganise ne-University of Southampton ekuqedeni izinqumo zazo ne-Turnitin, inkampani yokuthola ukukopela, emva kokuba iTurnitin iphakamise izinguquko zelayisensi ezingase zivumele ukuthi umsebenzi wabafundi osekilasini usetshenziselwe ukuqeqesha amathuluzi e-AI. INewcastle ibeke kugcizelela leli vesi mayelana nedatha; iWestminster ithe isihloli sokukopela se-Turnitin 'asisebenzi kahle' kumbhalo obhalwe yi-AI, futhi isihloli sayo se-AI 'sinobungozi obuvunyelwene bokuphumela kungamanga'. INyuvesi

yaseSouthampton yodwa ikhokhele iTurnitin amaponti angu-87,621 ngonyaka owodwa, kubafundi abangaphezu kuka-17,000 besemabangeni aphansi nabangu-8,000 beziqu eziphakeme.

> **Kungani kubalulekile:** Kwinsika ka-Wits AHEAD ephathelene ne-AI enokuzibophezela, ukuziphatha okulungile, ukulingana nenqubomgomo, lo mbango ukhombisa amanyuvesi eqala ukulinganisa ukubusa kwedatha kanye nokwethembeka kwangempela kwamathuluzi okuthola i-AI nezindleko, kunokubheka isinqumo sokuhlola ukukopela njengesidingo esingenakuguquka.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Funda emthonjeni

Luckhurst, G. (2026, October 9). More universities end Turnitin contracts as concerns mount. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/more-universities-end-turnitin-contracts-concerns-mount

UCWANINGO NEMIBIKO

Prepare students for post-graduation AI judgement challenges

University World News · 9 October 2026 · Pillar 4: Graduate capability and just transitions. Kwinsika ka-Wits AHEAD ephathelene ne-AI, ikhono labathweswe iziqu, ukuqasheka kanye noguquko olunobulungiswa, lokhu okutholakele kukhombisa ukuthi umsebenzi osizwe yi-AI ongalungile kodwa ozethembile ungabukeka unethonya njengomsebenzi oyiqiniso, okusho ukuthi ikhono abathweswe iziqu abalidinga kakhulu ngaphambi kokungena emsebenzini kungukwahlulela kochwepheshe, hhayi ukwazi i-AI kuphela.

Nguyen, P. (2026, October 9). Prepare students for post-graduation AI judgement challenges. *University World News*. universityworldnews.com/post.php?story=20261009115040153

South African minister tells universities to move from AI debate to decisions on teaching and research

South African Government News Agency (SAnews) · 8 October 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. Ngesinsika ka-Wits AHEAD mayelana ne-AI ekhiqizayo kwimfundo ephakeme, uNgqongqoshe wekhabhinethi obeka uhlelo oluqondile, mayelana nokufundisa, ukuhlolwa kanye namandla ocwaningo kunokuba yimpikiswano yodwa, unikeza amanyuvesi aseNingizimu Afrika igunya elicacile lokuthi asebenze ngalo.

South African Government News Agency. (2026, October 8). *Universities challenged to prepare graduates for AI-driven future*. SAnews. sanews.gov.za/node/84823

Study of students in China, Japan and Mongolia finds access to generative AI does not guarantee it is useful for learning

arXiv (working paper) · 4 October 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. Ngesinsika sika-Wits AHEAD mayelana ne-AI ekhiqizayo emfundweni ephakeme, okutholakele kokuthi ulimi nezimo zobuchwepheshe zasendaweni, hhayi ukuxhumana kuphela, yikho okunquma ukuthi i-AI ekhiqizayo iyabasiza ngempela yini abafundi ekufundeni kuyisexwayiso uWits AHEAD asisebenzisa ngokulinganayo kumathuluzi e-AI abuswa yisiNgisi asetshenziswa emakhampasini amaningi olimi aseNingizimu Afrika.

Li, M., Xie, Q., Enkhtur, A., Chen, L., & Cheng, F. (2026). From access to realized affordances: University students' generative AI engagement across linguistic and sociotechnical contexts. *arXiv*. arxiv.org/abs/2610.05301

OKUVELA EQENJINI

12 Sep 2026 **Ithisisi yobudokotela iqediwe; umfundi uzothweswa iziqu ngoZibandlela 2026**
Kwamukelwe izilungiso ezidingwe ngabahloli ocwaningweni olumayelana nabafundi abaphumelela kakhulu abafunda ngokufunda kude emfundweni ephakeme yaseMpumalanga Afrika.

12 Sep 2026 **Umbiko wocwaningo we-Masters uqediwe ngodumo; umfundi uzothweswa iziqu ngoZibandlela 2026**
Ukubuyekezwa kwe-bibliometric kobuholi nokwakhiwa kwenqubomgomo okusekelwe kudatha; isinyathelo esilandelayo yisiphakamiso se-PhD.

OKUFUNDWAYO ESIKUPHAKAMISAYO

Development as Freedom Amartya Sen, Oxford University Press (1999). Yilo u-H oku-AHEAD. Qala lapha.

With best wishes for the fortnight ahead,

Director: Wits AHEAD

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